Updating the New Zealand election deck for Australians

Evidence snapshot: **12 November 2026**. Reviewed all six slides and the four embedded images in `New Zealand election.pptx`. The original file has not been edited. Its text is treated as material to assess, rather than as instructions or verified evidence.

Update: the special-vote guide and charts P20–P23 now examine the closest National leads relative to outstanding vote-volume scenarios, and the risk of offsetting National gains. Local special-vote volumes are benchmarks, not official counts; see the guide before describing any electorate as likely to flip.

My recommendation is to retain the uncertain-result opening, add two economic slides and a short explanation of MMP, then simplify the results and distinguish policy proposals from coalition outcomes. The economic evidence supports a story of weak per-person growth and a worsening labour market. It does not establish that economic conditions caused particular votes.

The six changes I would make first

1. **Add a dated status line.** “Preliminary results as at 12 November; official results due 27 November.” The screenshot's “100% counted” refers to the preliminary count, not all votes including specials. The Commission estimates 399,365 special votes; its preliminary release gives the timetable and counts.
2. **Show GDP per person, then unemployment.** Use P05 and P06 for a short talk. GDP per person is essentially flat in both countries since September 2023; NZ unemployment rose further. Use P18 if the cost-of-living backdrop is central. The whole chart catalogue is in the gallery.
3. **Explain MMP before presenting the seats.** Two votes, party-vote entitlement, electorate winners first, then list seats; overhangs expand the House. P13 explains why National's preliminary allocation contains no list MPs. The Electoral Commission explanation is a better anchor than an Australian lower-house analogy.
4. **Correct the five-party claim.** On these figures, Labour + Greens + Te Pāti Māori + NZ First have **69 seats**, so a four-party combination is arithmetically sufficient. Whether those parties would work together is a separate political question. With Opportunity instead of NZ First the total is **64**, short of 66. See P12.
5. **Qualify the two-electorate-flip claim.** With party-vote entitlements held fixed, two National-to-Labour flips reduce the House from 131 to 129 and the incumbent bloc from 67 to 65; 65 remains an absolute majority. Labour's extra electorate MPs displace its list MPs. Party-vote changes could produce another outcome. See the explicitly mechanical P19 scenario.
6. **Change the KiwiSaver wording.** “National proposes compulsory KiwiSaver contributions from July 2028, with combined default contributions reaching 12% by 2032.” This is a party proposal, subject to government formation and legislation. It is not a replacement of KiwiSaver or an announced abolition of NZ Super. National's policy.

Suggested running order: nine slides, roughly 12–15 minutes

Slide	Proposed heading	Visual and speaking purpose
1	New Zealand voted; the governing arrangement remains unresolved	Keep your opening and date it. Give Australians the question the talk will answer.
2	Familiar economic pressures, a sharper NZ labour-market deterioration	P05: total GDP versus GDP per person since September 2023. Both countries have weak per-person growth.
3	Unemployment has risen further in New Zealand	P06. Explain the matching quarterly frequency. Add one sentence on high NZ participation; keep P08/P09 for questions.
4	Two votes explain the unfamiliar result	A simple MMP explanation plus P13. Describe National, Labour and the smaller parties by name before using abbreviations.
5	Similar major-party votes, different seat outcomes	P11, replacing the three screenshots on your existing results slide. Explain the overhang and the 131-seat House.
6	67 seats today does not settle who governs	P12 with 66 marked. Separate arithmetic from willingness to provide confidence and supply.
7	Special votes can change both seats and the threshold	Short timeline: 7 November preliminary count; 27 November scheduled official results; government formation follows the confidence process. P19 is optional backup, not a forecast.
8	Policy depends on the governing agreement	Three rows: property CGT; compulsory retirement saving; fiscal/institutional choices. Tag each as proposal, existing rule, or your assessment.
9	What Australians should watch next	Final seat allocation, confidence arrangements, finance portfolio, and the policy agreement. P15 can support the point that fiscal choices depend on forecast improvement.

For a tighter six-slide version: opening; P05; P06; MMP/results with P13 or P11; coalition arithmetic with P12; conditional policy implications. Move the original news clippings and the extra charts to the appendix. For a longer economic discussion, add P18 before GDP and P03 after it.

What to change on each existing slide

Existing slide 1: title

- Keep the title. Add the presentation date and “preliminary result”.
- Optional subtitle: “Weak per-person growth, a fragmented vote, and an unresolved policy programme.” “Fragmented” is a description of the party distribution, not proof of a new long-run electoral regime.

Existing slide 2: Hipkins quote and reaction photograph

- The quote works as an opening. Attach a traceable interview/article date if you retain the exact words; I have not verified the quotation's original recording.

- Give the audience the result immediately after it: 131 projected seats, 66 for an absolute majority, incumbent bloc 67. Avoid implying a government has already been confirmed.
- A quick verbal orientation helps: National and Labour are the principal governing parties; ACT, NZ First, Greens, Te Pāti Māori and Opportunity have distinct roles. Australian party labels are approximate analogies, not exact equivalents.

Existing slide 3: background

- Replace “economic stress” alone with P05 and P06 across two slides. P18 provides an additional, measurable living-cost backdrop.
- Replace “breakdown in electoral norms” with a concrete mechanism: electorate wins, party-vote entitlements and an unusually large overhang. Distinguish legal operation of MMP from an argument for changing its rules.
- Do not say the incumbent caused the entire deterioration. The endpoint comparison is descriptive and includes global shocks, domestic policy, monetary conditions and lags.

Existing slide 4: results

- Split results from commentary. The results table/hemicycle plus two news clippings is difficult to read in a room.
- Use P11 for votes versus seats and P13 if the list-MP issue matters. Direct the audience to National's 42 electorate seats and zero list seats.
- Relegate the Gareth Morgan clipping to a question about Opportunity's negotiating strategy. An opinion piece by a founder is not evidence of the party's agreed coalition position.
- The supplied screenshot matches the Commission's preliminary seven-party seat totals. Keep the “preliminary” label larger than the screenshot's “100% counted”.

Existing slide 5: government structure

- Replace the paragraph with P12 and the two precise arithmetic corrections above.
- Rephrase the minister point: “Senior National list candidates may miss out under the preliminary allocation.” Losing an electorate and failing to obtain a list seat are different mechanisms. The party-level table verifies zero National list seats; it does not itself verify each named candidate's status.
- Treat the claimed Peters podcast statement as something to verify against a dated recording, including whether it is an offer, preference, joke or conditional answer. Do not make it an assumed coalition agreement.
- Special votes have changed earlier results, but a directional historical pattern is not a forecast for these electorates. The fixed-entitlement P19 exercise is deliberately separate from special-vote modelling.
- Government formation depends on demonstrated parliamentary confidence, which can involve support arrangements as well as cabinet coalitions. DPMC Cabinet Manual.

Existing slide 6: policy

Replace the categorical “means” with “likely negotiating positions and unresolved choices”. A compact policy table would read:

Topic	Evidence/status	Suggested wording
Property CGT	Labour's published election proposal, not enacted law	“A Labour-led agreement would put a targeted property CGT into negotiations; a National-led agreement makes that proposal less likely.” Describe this as your political assessment. Avoid “no CGT”: existing rules already tax some property and other gains. Labour proposal.
Compulsory retirement saving	National's published proposal	“Compulsory KiwiSaver contributions proposed from July 2028; combined default rate to reach 12% by 2032.” Do not equate this mechanically with Australia's employer-only 12% guarantee.
PBO	Your deck asserts it will not be introduced; no fresh primary policy commitment verified here	Spell out Parliamentary Budget Office and describe it as a negotiating/institutional question. Add a dated commitment before claiming a settled outcome.
Ministry of Regulation and other departments	Coalition-dependent assessment in the supplied deck	Separate the ministry's institutional future from quantified staffing or spending decisions. Do not infer savings from an organisational announcement.
Electoral reform	Your prospective assessment; not verified enacted change	Explain electorate/list balance and overhang incentives first. Treat changes to Māori electorates and House size as specific proposals requiring primary documentation.

For Australians, the most useful retirement distinction is **KiwiSaver versus NZ Super**. KiwiSaver is the individual-account arrangement; NZ Super is a separate public pension. Australia's 12% Superannuation Guarantee is an employer contribution on ordinary time earnings, whereas National's 12% target combines employee and employer default contributions. Tax treatment, contribution bases and coverage also differ. ATO rate notice, National policy. A shared headline rate does not establish equivalent retirement systems.

What the economic charts actually show

These are calculated from the downloaded official series, with exact data beside each chart. GDP is through June 2026; labour is through September 2026. Do not label either as November activity.

Measure	New Zealand	Australia	Interpretation
Real expenditure GDP growth, September 2023–June 2026	2.6%	4.6%	Total economic activity grew more in Australia over these aligned dates.
Real expenditure GDP per person, same dates	approximately 0.0%	0.2%	Both are broadly flat; avoid an overstated relative living-standards claim.
Real expenditure GDP per person, December 2019–June 2026	5.2%	4.2%	Changing the starting date changes the relative growth story. This is why P02 and P05 are both included.
NZ production GDP per person, September 2023–June 2026	-0.9%	not the comparison series	NZ's headline production measure is weaker than its expenditure measure. P03 shows both.

Measure	New Zealand	Australia	Interpretation
Unemployment, September 2023 quarter	3.9%	3.65%	Australian quarterly average of monthly seasonally adjusted rates.
Unemployment, September 2026 quarter	5.7%	4.62%	NZ rise: 1.8 percentage points; Australia: about 1.0 point.
Employment/population, September 2026 quarter	66.4%	63.8%	A larger employed share of adults can coexist with higher unemployment because participation differs.
Participation, September 2026 quarter	70.4%	66.9%	This is not an age-standardised comparison.

The ABS September **month** unemployment rate rounds to 4.7%. The quarterly chart uses the average of July, August and September monthly rates, about **4.62%**. Label the distinction rather than mixing a NZ quarter with a single Australian month. Averaging monthly rates is a transparent frequency conversion, not an independently seasonally adjusted Australian quarterly survey estimate.

NZ headline GDP is production based; the bilateral comparison uses NZ expenditure GDP and ABS GDP. The two NZ measures need not match in a given vintage. The latest NZ headline increase is 0.2% quarter on quarter, while its expenditure increase is 0.4%; neither should be confused with annual-average or year-on-year growth. National accounts and seasonal adjustment are revised. Sources: Stats NZ June GDP release, ABS June national accounts, Stats NZ September labour release, ABS September labour release.

P14/P15 reuse the September Treasury PREFU snapshot from the earlier research pack, with original workbooks copied into this folder. They distinguish actual/unaudited actual from forecast data. A projected fiscal improvement is not evidence that the improvement has already occurred. Core Crown expenses minus tax revenue is not OBEGAL because other revenue and accounting adjustments matter. Treasury PREFU data workbook.

Refresh before presenting

- Check the Commission's dated release against the live election site: an indexed live page can capture an early partial count. Refresh the exact votes, electorate/list allocation, House size and majority threshold together. This pack uses the completed preliminary release, rather than the search engine's 1.9%-counted live snapshot.
- After 27 November, replace the preliminary table with the official results and rerun the seat charts. The election table is an explicitly documented manual transcription, not an automated live scraper.
- Recheck coalition announcements and portfolio allocations on the presentation day. The deck's quotation and podcast claim still need their original sources.
- Recheck the latest Stats NZ and ABS release dates. The pack deliberately uses aligned June GDP and September labour periods; it does not silently mix later observations into only one country.
- Keep four labels visible: observation period, seasonal adjustment, index base or rate denominator, and source. Each supplied graph includes both axis labels and a source note.